

The Ontario Business AI Readiness Checklist

A 20-point self-assessment to find your first AI automation opportunity. Score each item honestly - the goal is to identify where AI can save real hours, not to get a perfect score.

How to score: 0 = Not at all 1 = Sometimes 2 = Mostly automated N/A = Does not apply

1. Lead & Customer Handling

- ☐ Leads are responded to within 1 hour during business hours.
- ☐ After-hours inquiries get an automated response so no lead goes cold.
- ☐ Every lead is qualified (budget, timeline, need) before a human touches it.
- ☐ Appointment booking is self-serve or automated (no back-and-forth emails).
- ☐ Lead data flows into your CRM automatically - no manual data entry.

2. Customer Support & Communication

- ☐ Customers can get instant answers to common questions outside business hours.
- ☐ Repeated questions (hours, pricing, availability) are documented in a searchable knowledge base.
- ☐ Customer emails are triaged by priority before a team member reads them.
- ☐ Unanswered questions are logged so you can improve your knowledge base over time.

3. Operations & Admin

- ☐ Invoices are generated and sent without manual effort.
- ☐ Recurring reports (weekly KPIs, monthly summaries) are produced automatically.
- ☐ Data from different tools (CRM, accounting, scheduling) is synced without manual entry.
- ☐ Internal documents are searchable and organized - nobody wastes time hunting for files.

4. Document Processing

- ☐ Incoming documents (PDFs, emails, forms) are sorted and routed automatically.
- ☐ Data extraction from documents (names, amounts, dates) is handled without manual typing.
- ☐ Contracts and proposals are generated from templates with auto-filled client data.

5. Decision Support & Reporting

- ☐ You have a real-time dashboard showing your most important business metrics.
- ☐ Anomalies (unusual drop in sales, spike in complaints) are flagged automatically.
- ☐ You get plain-English summaries of business performance instead of raw spreadsheets.

Your Score

Count how many boxes you checked (0-20):

0-5 checked	High opportunity. Your business has significant room for AI-driven time savings. A single automation could save 10+ hours per week.
6-10 checked	Moderate opportunity. You have some systems but clear gaps. Targeting 2-3 workflows could yield meaningful efficiency gains.
11-15 checked	Good foundation. You are ahead of most small businesses. Focus on the remaining unchecked areas for incremental gains.
16-20 checked	Excellent. You are well-automated. AI can still help with advanced tasks: predictive analytics, intelligent decision support, or natural language interfaces.

Your Next Step

Pick the 3 unchecked items that would save the most time if automated. Then answer these questions for each:

1. How many hours per week does this task currently take?
2. How many people are involved in this task?
3. What happens when this task is done late or incorrectly (lost leads, missed deadlines, unhappy customers)?
4. What tool or system does this task currently live in (email, spreadsheet, CRM, paper)?

Get your free AI Opportunity Audit

In 20 minutes, we will review your checklist, map 3 automation opportunities specific to your business, and recommend one quick win you can ship first. No cost, no obligation.

Book your audit: calendly.com/hirenthakore/ai-automation-discovery-call

Or email: hello@grandriverai.ca | Call: (226) 975-9417